

Analysis

1 Describe the privacy concerns related to the 'Age My Face' app and its terms and conditions. What data did the app have access to, and why was this problematic for users?

2 How did Cambridge Analytica use Facebook data, and what impact did its actions have on the US Presidential election in 2016? Explain how data collected from social media can potentially influence larger societal and political events.

CASE STUDY 6.19

Pokémon GO (again)

The other side of *Pokémon GO*'s success was its use of data to track, predict and, in some cases, control human behaviour. The team behind the game's design were able to track the physical movements of players in real time and, in some cases, direct whole herds of people to specific locations in search of Pokémons to capture. This led to public spaces, shopping centres and, at times, into private property. As Zuboff articulated 'the seeds of behaviour modification are planted within the game's rules and social dynamics'. In quoting the game's developer John Hanke, Zuboff continues 'if you want to turn the world into your game board, you (the players) need to have a reason to go there … The game is enabling them and nudging you to have those social interactions'.[13]

Pokémon GO is a game. But it uses player data to track, predict and control behaviour without the player's knowledge. Imagine if this technology was placed in the wrong hands? Or is it already there?

Analysis

1 How did *Pokémon GO* utilise player data to influence human behaviour and encourage specific physical movements?

2 According to Zuboff, how are the 'seeds of behaviour modification' planted within the game's design and social dynamics? Provide a quote from the game's developer that supports this idea.

ACTIVITY 6.15

Class debate

Consider the following two statements:

1 Article 12 of the United Nations Declaration of Human Rights states:

> 'No one shall be subjected to arbitrary interference with his privacy, family, home or correspondence, nor to attacks upon his honour and reputation. Everyone has the right to the protection of the law against such interference or attacks.'[14]

2 In 2010, Facebook owner Mark Zuckerberg was quoted as saying: 'Privacy is no longer a "social norm" as we have evolved beyond that.'[15]

Divide the class into the affirmative and negative. Devise three arguments based on evidence that responds to this statement:

> 'Society has evolved beyond the need for privacy.'

ISBN 978-1-009-36510-9 Hoban et al © Cambridge University Press & Assessment 2023
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